

- Do try and pay back whatever amount you can. Usually receiving something is better than nothing.
- Don't lie to your friend. Be honest about why you can't repay them right now.
- Do thank them for loaning you the money and promise to do your best to repay them as soon as possible.
- Don't let a friendship be lost over money.

It is normal to feel hurt and disappointed when the borrower doesn't repay the loan. Broken promises and avoidance often compound these feelings. When your friend or relative avoids your phone calls, won't answer your requests for payment, or stops all contact with you, it is hard not to feel betrayed.

When this happens, you must decide if the relationship is more important than the money. If that is the case, you may want to, in effect, write-off the loan. The danger in doing so is to establish a pattern of loaning money and not expecting it to be repaid. This can result in a financial parent/child relationship. A dependency upon the financial parent can cause the financial child to lose their willingness to become self-sufficient.

Rhonda failed to understand that sometimes the best way to help a friend is not to help them at all. Rhonda knew Devin very well and should have realized that old habits die hard. When he didn't make his car payment, he was continuing his previous behavior. By enabling Devin to continue on with his irresponsible financial behavior, Rhonda was not helping Devin as she thought she was. Ironically, she was actually hurting him. Since he was never responsible for the consequences of his actions, he was never forced to change.

Best friends can be more honest with one another than can casual acquaintances. The truth can be blunt, but it hurts less than a broken friendship. If Rhonda had been honest with

